

Long-Distance Caregiving Checklist

Build a practical support net when you cannot quickly get to your parent in person.

Privacy note: This checklist is for your personal/family use. Parent Stay Home does not receive, save, store, or see anything you type into the web version. Keep completed copies only where appropriate and share only with trusted or authorized people.

Parent and primary helper information

Parent's full name	
Date updated	
Parent's street address	
City	
State / ZIP	
Primary out-of-town helper	
Primary helper phone/email	
Best local person to call first	
Best local person phone/email	

Local support contacts

List nearby people who may be able to check on your parent, meet a responder, unlock a door, pick up something urgent, or help with a practical need. Ask permission before listing someone as a helper.

#	Name	Relationship / role	Phone	Email / notes
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

Medical communication access

Before there is an urgent need, ask each doctor's office, specialist, hospital system, pharmacy, and insurance plan what authorization, HIPAA release, portal access, or representative documentation is required so trusted family members or helpers can receive information when appropriate.

Important access note: Requirements can vary by office, facility, provider, plan, state, and situation. This checklist is for organizing questions and contacts only. It is not legal, medical, financial, or care-management advice.

#	Doctor / office / facility	Phone	Who is authorized?	Release on file?	Date confirmed / notes
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Home access and emergency plan

Who has a spare key or safe access?	
Emergency entry instructions or lockbox notes	
Trusted neighbor / building contact	
Alarm, gate, or building access notes	
Pet care instructions if parent is hospitalized	
Utility shutoff / landlord / maintenance contact	

Services and daily needs

- ☐ Transportation options identified
- ☐ Meal delivery or food support identified
- ☐ Pharmacy and medication refill process known
- ☐ Home safety concerns noted
- ☐ Local aging agency or county resource identified
- ☐ Backup caregiver/helper identified
- ☐ Important papers location known
- ☐ Bill/payment awareness discussed
- ☐ Emergency information sheet completed
- ☐ Family communication plan discussed

Additional daily needs, worries, or service gaps	
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Action tracker

Turn worries into smaller next steps. Mark urgent items as Now.

Safety note: If your parent may be in immediate danger, cannot access food, has urgent medication concerns, may be wandering, or has a medical emergency, contact emergency services or an appropriate qualified professional right away.

#	Concern / task	Priority (Now / Next / Later)	Who to contact	Next step / notes
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				